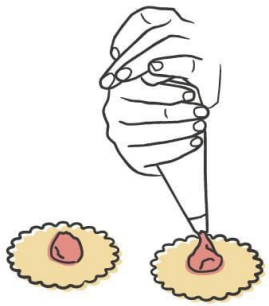
CASUNZIEI

REGION	REST
Veneto, in Cortina d'Ampezzo, a ski town in the Dolomite range	**45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator**

METHOD

1. Make the egg dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Lay one sheet on the board. Cut rounds with a #70 (2 3/4-inch) fluted pastry cutter, leaving 1/8 inch between them.
4. Load the filling into a pastry bag cut to a 1/2-inch opening. Pipe a quarter-sized dab into the middle of each round. The classic beet filling is loose, so pipe carefully.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist the rounds with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Hold a round in your palm and fold the top half over the bottom half, lining up the edges, to make a half-moon.
7. Pinch the edge shut around the filling with thumb and index finger. Work back and forth a few times and push all the air out.
8. Set the piece on the prepared pan. Fill and fold the rest of the rounds, keeping them in a single layer, and dust the pan again with semolina.
9. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
10. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

SHAPING



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NOTES

Cut from 2 3/4-inch rounds (#70 fluted cutter), spaced 1/8 inch apart on the sheet. Fluted only, no plain option given.
Filling per piece: a quarter-sized circle piped through a 1/2-inch opening.
Seal geometry: a plain half-moon. Fold, pinch the edge closed, done. There is no dimple and no collar, which is what separates it from cappelletti cut off the same #70 cutter.
Air must be forced out of the edge as you pinch.
The beet filling is looser than most, so it needs a careful hand at the piping stage.
Green and golden versions exist, built on alpine herbs, turnips, or potato, but the beet-filled version is the one associated with Cortina.
Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
Served with the classic alpine finish of foamy butter, poppy seeds, and smoked ricotta.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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